Taliban in Quetta and elsewhere. Regardless of the agenda, this policy of harbouring TTP and letting them attack Pakistanis severely undermined the US-Pakistan ally status, weakened the efforts to bring peace in the region and further increased the mistrust between Pakistan and Afghanistan.

As long Fazlullah and Maulvi Faqir Muhammad were not subdued in Afghanistan, complete peace could not be guaranteed in Swat and other areas adjacent to Kunar and Nuristan provinces. They remained a significant threat not only to the stability of the north-western borders of Pakistan but also to peace and tranquillity in KP and other provinces of Pakistan.

According to a report of the International Crisis Group:

> Since July 2009, the military and many in the media have hailed the Swat operation as Pakistan's most successful counter-insurgency operation ever. Yet more than three years later, pledges that the TNSM, Pakistani Taliban and other militant leaders would be brought to justice are unfulfilled. The military has used the pace of IDP returns as the main gauge of success. Most have indeed returned, but their lives have fundamentally changed for the worse, with the conflict and continued militancy radically transforming the region's economic, social and political complexion.
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> Even as the military suggests that the civilian leadership's unwillingness to assume responsibility over Malakand has undermined the 'clear, hold, build' strategy, it shows no signs of wanting to extricate itself from the region. But the longer PATA's militarisation continues, and the deeper it goes, the greater the costs of the conflict (Crisis Group Asia Report, 2013).

TTP PUNJAB CHAPTER

The TTP Punjab chapter was founded in July/August 2009. They were called Punjabi Taliban. According to intelligence reports, the TTP Commander Hussain Mehsud presided at a meeting at Imran Hotel Noor Din Market (weapons market), Miramshah, North Waziristan, and formed this chapter. He addressed about ten participants and stated that it was essential to carry out terrorist activities in Punjab in order to divert the attention from counter-insurgency in FATA to counter